▼ GLASSHOUSE



HOW TO LOSE AN ELECTION

The Congress keeps finding ways to lose elections it could have salvaged. This time, it's **Kanhaiya Kumar,** who minds the party's student wing, NSUI, in the dock after rebel candidate **Deepanshu Shokeen** won the Delhi University student's union (DUSU) vice-president's post with 30,615 votes. The NSUI's official candidate, Vir Chatrath, son of AICC member Manish Chatrath, managed just 4,313 votes, even less than NOTA. Shokeen says he was overlooked for a candidate who had been "parachuted in from London". The Congress counters that he was offered the nomination for the president's post but had declined to fight fellow Jat, Yash Dabas, the candidate of the ABVP, the BJP's student wing. In the end, the story is that a bus conductor's son trounced the organisation's chosen face, bringing scrutiny again to the party's handling of nominations.

Illustrations by **SIDDHANT JUMDE**

▼ BACKHANDED CRITICISM

A FEW FILO-FACTS



Bihar chief minister **Samrat Choudhary** still describes ex-CM Nitish Kumar as the "tallest" NDA leader in the state. But at the Aaj Tak Panchayat in Patna on September 18, the CM also offered a revealing contrast in governance between him and his predecessor. During his years with Nitish, Choudhary claimed, he had seen people come to meet the CM five times a year with the same request, the application moving to the bottom of the pile each time. Choudhary says he has introduced a statewide digital system now that has disposed of 96 per cent of the 850,000 applications that have come his government's way. The successor, it seems, is now advertising a different model of running Bihar.